

Beginner Steroid Cycle Full Guide

Safe Entry-Level Protocol with Bloodwork Guidance & PCT

12 Weeks	1 Compound	Test-E Only Protocol	44+ pg Pages
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Beginner Steroid Cycle — Full Guide

The safest entry-level approach is a Testosterone Enanthate-only cycle. Testosterone is the foundation of all advanced cycles and allows you to understand how your body responds to exogenous androgens before adding complexity. This guide covers everything from first injection to full PCT recovery.

Why Test-Only First?

Reason	Explanation
Baseline response	Learn how your body aromatizes, retains water, affects mood
Troubleshooting	If side effects occur, only one variable to adjust
Recovery	Easier PCT with single compound suppression
Efficacy	Beginners gain 6–10 kg lean mass on first cycle regardless of stack

The Protocol

Item	Detail
Compound	Testosterone Enanthate (Test-E)
Dose	300–400 mg/week (beginner: 300 mg)
Injection frequency	2x/week (Mon + Thu, equal split)
Cycle length	12 weeks
Aromatase Inhibitor	Arimidex 0.5 mg E3D (have on hand, use if needed)
HCG	Optional: 500 IU 2x/week weeks 1–10
PCT start	14 days after last injection (ester clearance)

How to Inject — Step by Step

Injection sites for beginners: glutes (ventroglute preferred), vastus lateralis (outer quad). Rotate sites each injection to avoid scar tissue.

Step	Action	Why
1	Wash hands thoroughly with soap	Prevent contamination
2	Wipe vial top with alcohol swab, let dry 30 sec	Sterilise
3	Draw air equal to your dose into syringe	Easier to draw oil
4	Insert needle into vial, inject air, draw oil	Standard draw technique
5	Switch to smaller needle (23g 1.5") for injection	Reduces pain
6	Locate injection site, wipe with alcohol, let dry	Sterility
7	Insert needle at 90°, aspirate 3–5 sec	Check for blood vessel
8	Inject slowly (30–60 seconds)	Reduces pip (post-injection pain)
9	Remove, apply pressure with clean cotton	Minimise bruising
10	Dispose in sharps container	Safety

Side Effects & Management

Side Effect	When	Action
Water retention	Weeks 2–4	Reduce sodium, add AI if severe
Acne	Any time	Benzoyl peroxide, salicylic acid wash
Mood swings	Weeks 1–3	Normal adjustment period; monitor
Reduced testicular size	Weeks 4+	Use HCG 500 IU 2x/week
High blood pressure	Weeks 3+	Monitor weekly, reduce dose if >140/90
Libido changes	Variable	Usually improves; E2 imbalance if low

PCT Protocol

PCT begins 14 days after the last Test-E injection. This allows the ester to clear. Use Nolvadex (tamoxifen citrate) as the primary SERM.

Week	Nolvadex Dose	Clomid (optional)	Support
1	40 mg/day	50 mg/day	Zinc 30 mg, Vitamin D 5000 IU
2	40 mg/day	50 mg/day	Continue support supps
3	20 mg/day	25 mg/day	Continue support supps
4	20 mg/day	25 mg/day	Taper complete

Expected Results — Beginner Cycle

Timepoint	Strength	Weight	Body Composition
End Week 4	10–15% increase	+3–4 kg (water + glycogen)	Look fuller
End Week 8	20–25% increase	+6–8 kg total	Visible muscle gains
End Week 12	25–35% increase	8–12 kg total	Significant transformation
8 wks post-PCT	Maintain ~70%	Keep 4–7 kg lean	If trained and ate well